

CAMSAIL PROGRAMME

2024 – 2025

Winter Programme for Sailors **Living In or Near Cambridge**

CAMSAIL is a club which meets monthly from October to March to enjoy a wide range of illustrated talks, given by invited speakers and club members, and provides an opportunity to socialise in a nautical atmosphere (albeit in central Cambridge!).

Our monthly meetings are on Wednesday evenings at 19.30 for 19.45. We meet in the Cambridge and County Bowling Club, Brooklands Avenue, CB2 8FG. The club is situated towards the west end of Brooklands Avenue on the north side, and parking is available there. There is a bar open before each meeting.

There is an annual subscription (to cover the cost of the venue and speakers' expenses), but those new to us are welcome to attend one meeting without charge or any commitment to join.

October 9th: Harry King & Sons Boatyard, Pin Mill

Sarah Curtis runs Harry King & Sons boatyard with her husband Gus, who has been working at the yard for 35 years. The couple were asked to continue the King's legacy by Harry King's grandson, Geoff, when he retired in 2005. Local girl Sarah grew up sailing the Smack *Dorothy* which was rebuilt by her stepfather and shipwright Joe Dunnett. She is writing a book on the boatyard's history.

November 13th: Round The World in Five Years

David & Liz White agreed that they should wait until their boys were out of nappies before starting this trip. Inevitably it was some time after this before they set off with their two boys, who were then five and eight years old! This talk is about their five year circumnavigation, all four of them in a 34ft yacht, from 1997 to 2002 and some of their experiences along the way.

December 11th: Members' Evening

Camsail AGM; election of Committee for 2025; a chance to share sailing experiences and to get to know other members better (with Christmas refreshments), including reports from the Camsail trips of last season.

Our club, now in its fifteenth season, has a membership of around 50. Some of the members have or have had their own yachts, others enjoy sailing by chartering or as crew, others have sailed in the past or are simply interested in things nautical!

We organise trips during the Spring & Autumn, and try to help skippers looking for crew and vice versa.

Our club welcomes a connection with the Cruising Association (www.theca.org.uk) through their Suffolk Section. The Camsail programme is published in the C.A. quarterly magazine.

Committee (2025):

President: Peter Jones

Chairman: Jim Hibbert

Secretary: John Aylmer

Treasurer: Malcolm Dee

Member: Ann Jackson

Member: John Peregrine

If you would like further details, please visit our website:

www.camsail.org.uk

or contact us at: enquiries@camsail.org.uk

January 8th: Samuel Pepys

David Davies is the chairman of the Society for Nautical Research. His books *Pepys's Navy* and *Kings of the Sea: Charles II, James II and the Royal Navy* won the Pepys and Anderson prizes respectively. Samuel Pepys, a Huntingdon man and founder of one of Cambridge's finest libraries, is best known as a lively diarist. But he was also perhaps the most influential naval administrator in British history, knew the east coast well and was closely involved with the development of the dockyard at Harwich, where he also served as MP.

February 12th: Flotilla Sailing from 2 viewpoints

John Aylmer enjoyed his twenty second sailing trip in Croatian waters in September 2022. About half of those trips were flotilla sailing, initially as client and then later as helper/instructor. John will describe what has drawn him to those waters for so long, and some of his experiences on both sides of that flotilla experience.

March 12th: The Clipper Round the World Race

Mark Humphries in 2019 discovered the Clipper Round the World Yacht Race just as the fleet of 11 matched yachts were about to set off on the 2019-20 race from St Katherine Docks in London. Weeks later, Mark had signed up to Leg 1 of the next race despite having no real sailing experience. He will talk about his 4 year journey from novice to ocean yacht racer with over 8,000 miles in his log book. He will cover the training, preparation and the race from Portsmouth to Punte del Este in Uruguay.